

Growing a Canadian Payroll Career Coaching Business Through Facebook & Instagram Ads

How a research-first strategy generated 2,195 qualified leads in 4 month



Executive Summary

A Canadian payroll career coaching business needed a reliable way to attract new immigrants seeking a stable career path. Starting with in-depth research, a dedicated landing page, and four months of continuous testing across audiences, messaging, and creative, the campaign built a repeatable lead generation system — delivering 2,195 qualified leads and lowering the cost per lead from \$3.53 to as low as \$1.86.

Project Snapshot

Metric	Result
Industry	Payroll Education, Career Coaching & Consulting
Target Market	Canada
Campaign Duration	4 Months
Campaign Objective	Generate Qualified Leads
Total Ad Spend	\$4,252

About the Client

The client runs a Canadian payroll career coaching business that helps newcomers to Canada build careers in payroll. Their business model works in three stages:

- Attract prospects with a free payroll information session.
- Convert attendees into paying students.
- Support graduates with ongoing career guidance and consulting.

For this model to work, the business needed a steady flow of high-quality leads entering the top of the funnel.

The Business Challenge

The client had a strong educational offer, but faced a few common marketing hurdles:

- Generating a consistent volume of qualified leads.
- Lowering the cost of acquiring each new customer.
- Improving lead quality, not just lead volume.
- Building a marketing funnel aligned with long-term growth goals.
- Understanding which messages would resonate with new immigrants exploring career options.

The goal was never just to “run some ads.” It was to build a scalable system for generating leads that could support sustainable growth.

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Breakdown

Off... ↑↓	Campaign ↑↓	Delivery ↑	Results ↑↓	Cost per result ↑↓	Budget ↑↓	Amount spent ↑↓	Impressions ↑↓	Reach ↑↓	Clicks (all) ↑↓	Viewers ↑↓
☒	Leads Webinar Reg. Canada	Active	955 Website leads	\$1.86 Per lead	\$20.00 Daily	\$1,775.23	163,267	49,316	6,695	
☐	EOS Pro-Relaunch Webinar CA Job Tit...	Off	145 Website leads	\$2.23 Per lead	\$43.20 Daily	\$323.72	27,913	17,694	764	
☐	EOS Pro Webinar CA Employment + J...	Off	258 Website leads	\$2.15 Per lead	\$70.00 Daily	\$554.75	46,401	29,881	1,275	
☐	EOS Pro Webinar CA Job Titles + Job ...	Off	457 Website leads	\$1.46 Per lead	\$34.56 Daily	\$667.83	64,897	32,239	2,230	
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Results from 7 campaigns										

Project Objectives

- Generate qualified leads through Meta Ads.
- Improve lead quality while keeping acquisition costs efficient.
- Identify the audience segments most likely to convert.
- Find the creative messaging and emotional triggers that worked best.
- Build a repeatable advertising framework that could scale over time.

Research & Strategy

Before any ads went live, the business, its offer, its competitors, and its audience were studied closely. The research covered:

- The client's website and how the offer was positioned.
- Competitor ads and landing page structure.
- The customer journey, from first click to enrolment.
- What motivates the audience and what career goals they hold.

- Where the strongest messaging opportunities existed.

Instead of sending paid traffic to the existing website, a dedicated landing page was built specifically for Meta Ads visitors, using a simple, focused conversion path:

Attention → Interest → Trust → Reduce Doubt → Action

This kept the visitor focused on one clear next step: registering for the client's free payroll information session.

Campaign Approach: Four Phases

Phase 1 — Market Validation

The first campaign had two jobs: generate early leads, and gather real audience insights. Rather than guessing what would work, this phase tested different messages, creatives, and offers, and tracked closely how the audience responded.

A few emotional themes came through as especially strong drivers:

- Fear of unemployment
- Immigration-related challenges
- Financial insecurity
- Career uncertainty
- Desire for long-term stability
- Higher earning potential
- Professional confidence
- Career growth opportunities

These insights became the foundation for every creative and message that followed.

Phase 2 — Data-Driven Optimization

With initial data in hand, the focus shifted to lead quality and lower acquisition costs. Optimization touched several levers:

- Audience targeting
- Age segmentation
- High-performing audience behaviors
- Creative selection
- Budget allocation

Every change was based on what the campaign data showed, not assumptions — and it paid off in stronger lead quality and better efficiency.

Phase 3 — Structured A/B Testing

To find the best-performing combination of audience, message, and creative, a structured testing program was built around three areas:

- Audience Testing — different segments, demographics, and interest groups
- Creative Testing — multiple concepts, messaging angles, and visual styles
- Campaign Optimization — refining structure based on results

Every test was measured against lead quality and cost per lead, which made it possible to identify the audiences, messages, and creatives that consistently performed best.

Phase 4 — Performance Optimization & Scaling

Once clear, reliable patterns emerged, all the learnings were combined into one optimized campaign — pairing the winning audiences, best-performing creatives, and proven messaging inside a streamlined structure.

Rather than scaling by simply increasing budget, the focus stayed on efficiency. This phase produced the project's lowest cost per lead, without sacrificing lead quality. From here, management centered on monitoring performance and making small, ongoing improvements based on live results.

Campaign Results

KPI	Result
Total Leads	2,195
Total Ad Spend	\$4,252
Average Cost per Lead	\$2.14
Lowest Cost per Lead	\$1.86
Total Reach	178,864
Total Impressions	390,210

Business Impact

Beyond the lead numbers, this project gave the client a lasting lead generation system. Specifically, it:

- Created a dedicated, conversion-focused marketing funnel.
- Identified the audience segments most likely to convert.
- Uncovered the emotional messaging that resonated most.
- Improved lead quality through continuous optimization.
- Reduced acquisition costs over time through data-driven decisions.
- Supported the client's long-term student acquisition strategy.

Key Takeaways

- Research should shape strategy before a single ad goes live.
- A dedicated landing page matters as much as the ads themselves.
- Treat the first campaign as a learning opportunity, not the finished product.
- Data-driven decisions consistently beat guesswork.
- Ongoing testing is essential to keep improving both lead quality and cost.

Conclusion

This project shows what a structured, research-led Meta Ads strategy can achieve: consistent, high-quality leads, and a cost per lead that keeps improving over time. By combining audience research, a focused conversion funnel, systematic testing, and continuous optimization, the campaign grew into a scalable acquisition system built to support the client's long-term goals.